

“Prayer for Strength”

The poem “Prayer for Strength” has been written by the renowned Indian poet, Rabindranath Tagore. The poem is in the form of a prayer in which the poet requests the Almighty to give him the strength that would make him kind and compassionate. He implores God to give him strength to bear his joys and sorrows equally. The poet feels that God should help him in making love fruitful in the service of mankind. He also craves for the strength with which he could own the poor and the destitute. The poet finally has a yearning that he should submit and surrender himself before Almighty. The poet also has a desire that he should always stand for truth and should never bend before the cruel powers.

Comprehension:

Q1. Why does the poet want God to strike his heart?

Ans. The poet wants God to strike his heart to get rid of all hatred and jealousy and to fill it with kindness, love and compassion for others.

Q2. What does the poet want the strength for?

Ans. The poet wants the strength to bear his joys and sorrows equally and to make his love fruitful in the service of humanity. He also wants the strength to rise above all insignificant things. He also wants to have the strength so that he could face the insolent powers bravely. The poet also seeks strength to surrender before His will.

Q3. How can love be made meaningful in one’s life?

Ans. Love can be made meaningful in one’s life if it can help the society to prosper, if it can wipe the tears and remove the sufferings from the society:

Q4. What should be our attitude towards the poor?

Ans. Our attitude towards the poor should be that of love, kindness and respect.

Q5. What does ‘bend my knees’ signify?

Ans. ‘Bend my knees’ means bowing down, surrendering before something, giving up one’s principles. In the poem, ‘bend my knees’ reflect the weakness for human beings when they have to surrender before evil forces. That’s why the poet requests God to give him strength so that he can fight against devilish forces.

Q6. Why does the poet want to raise his mind high above 'daily trifles'?

Ans. The poet wants to raise his mind high above daily trifles because he wants to broaden his vision so that he doesn't waste his time and energy on things that are insignificant.

Q7. Why does the poet ask for strength to surrender his will to God's will?

Ans. The poet asks for strength to surrender his will to God's will because he wants to let go of his selfish desires and accept whatever God chooses for him.